

Good morning everyone,

Firstly, I would like to apologise for not being there in person due to my medical condition, which is severely aggravated by stress of any kind and can trigger immediate neurological attacks.

I have been suffering from chronic Vestibular Migraine for 15 years, experiencing up to 20 attacks per month. My triggers include lack of sleep, disturbances during the night, not eating on time, loud noises, sudden sounds, and any form of stress. My neurological team at Guy's & St Thomas' Hospital recognise the severity of this illness and have explained that there is no effective pain relief. They have also confirmed that the pain during an attack is debilitating and reaches a level that is clinically comparable to torture-level pain — far beyond what any person could reasonably be expected to withstand.

Despite this, our neighbours Lucy and Josh seem to have forgotten a simple act of humanity, continuing to cause significant discomfort, disruption, and ill health to their neighbours while still profiting from it.

Across almost every major religion and moral tradition, the principle of “treat your neighbour as yourself” — the Golden Rule — appears in almost identical wording. Judaism, Christianity, Islam, Hinduism, Buddhism, Sikhism, and Jainism all teach the same thing: love others the way you want to be loved. Unfortunately, this value seems to have been ignored here.

Since they moved in, the frequency of my attacks has increased dramatically. It began with their dog barking at 6am on Saturday and Sunday, followed by loud screaming from children, parents speaking loudly, nursery songs being sung, and constant slamming of car doors and house doors — all happening repeatedly, one after another. These noises have caused ongoing suffering and deterioration to my health.

I also find it extremely self-centred that Lucy and Josh refuse to inconvenience themselves by using their own separate entrances, instead choosing behaviour that causes significant distress to their neighbours.

Last year, in early October at about 4:30pm, my gardener came to blow some leaves for just five minutes. Josh came to my door — I greeted him with a smile — and he said, “Your gardener!” I offered him the gardener's number, and he said, “No, he is disturbing my peace. Ask him to leave.” His peace at 4:30pm seems to matter more than the wellbeing and health of those around him.

On two occasions, my daughter Natasha was in the garden and saw men looking through the fence gaps. Natasha is 24 but looks much younger — this is unacceptable and deeply concerning. How is it possible that people attending their activities have access to look directly into our garden, which is meant to be a private, safe space for our family?

We also regularly find food wrappers and rubbish thrown onto our driveway through the side opening by children attending their sessions.

My children work extremely hard all week. The weekend is their only time to rest, lie in, and recover — yet their sleep, peace, and health are being severely affected by the constant disturbances.

Allandale is usually extremely peaceful from around 4:30pm onwards, and throughout weekends. On Saturdays and Sundays, the only sound you would normally hear is the birds.

That peace has now been taken away.

I strongly urge Josh and Lucy to bring these sessions to an end. No one should impose on others an environment or level of distress that they themselves would never tolerate. It is only fair, humane, and respectful to ensure that neighbours do not suffer in ways they would refuse to experience themselves.

